

Tide

for 6 players

Oliver Thurley, 2013

Tide

(after Hiroshi Sugimoto's *Seascapes*)

Duration: 40'00"

A variable set of instruments are softly struck or sustained in unison.

Instrumentation

Player 1

Acoustic Guitar
Vibraphone
Timpani
Bass Drum

Player 4

Zither
Trombone
Triangle
Bass Drum

Player 2

Piano
Triangle
Cymbal
Floor Tom

Player 5

Electric Guitar
Zither
Cymbal
Timpano

Player 3

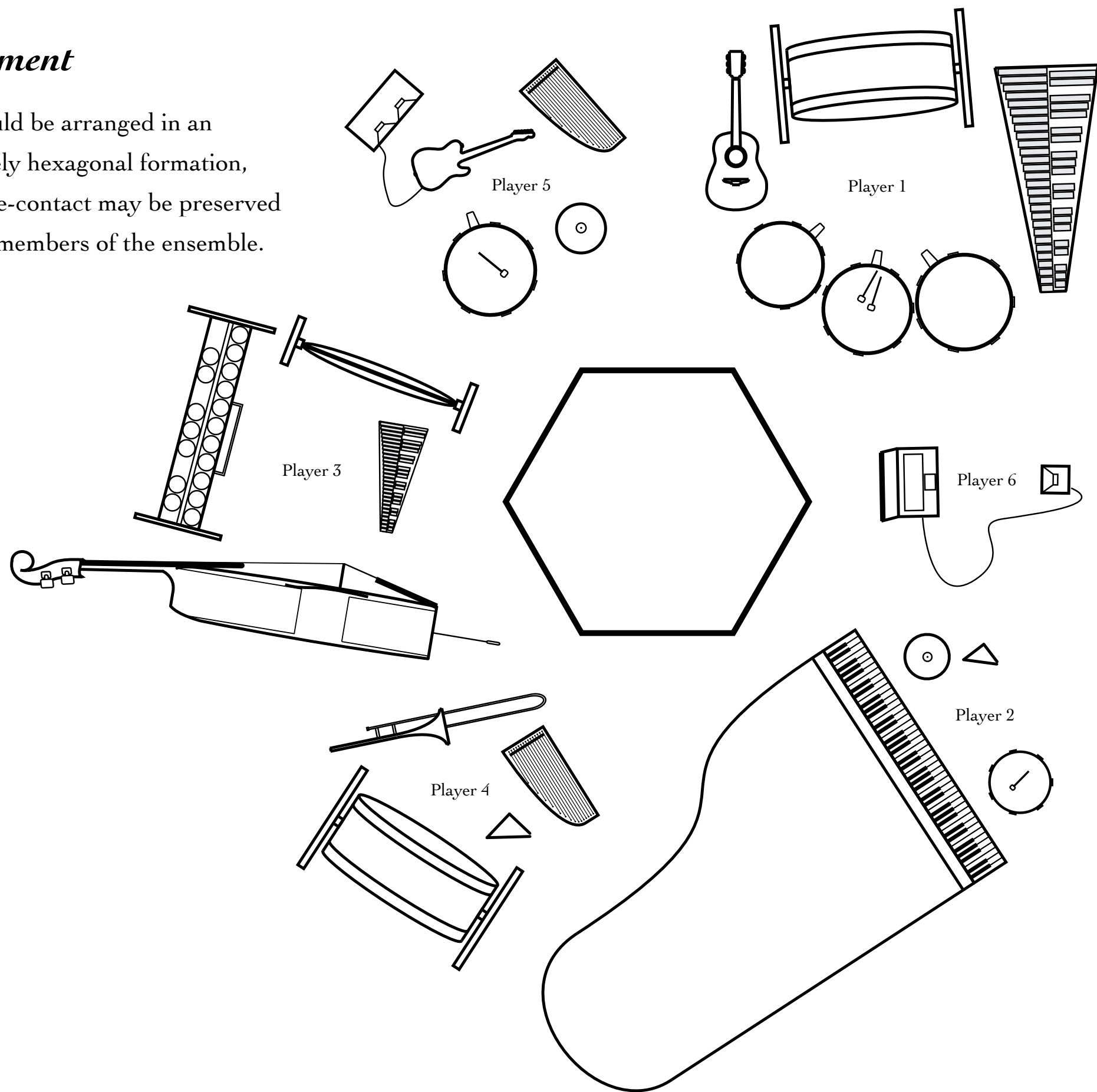
Glockenspiel
Double Bass
Tamtam
Tubular Bells

Player 6

Sine Waves

Arrangement

Players should be arranged in an approximately hexagonal formation, such that eye-contact may be preserved between all members of the ensemble.



Notation

The score is arranged in time-space format, with each page representing 2 minutes. The ensemble should use a common clock source (i.e. a master clock, or synchronised stopwatches) to ensure that all events are played together. If the ensemble requires a conductor, it is recommended that player 6 assumes this role.

Each player has 4 instruments (discounting player 6, who solely operates the sine waves), which they change between throughout the performance. Not all players will participate in *every* attack event. The piece should be very quiet, as such player's movement between instruments should be kept to a minimum. The instrument, and where required, pitch class is displayed below each player's attack (shown as a shaded circle). See the *Performance Notes* for individual information on how each instrument should be played.

This version of the score lasts 40 minutes (20 pages), however if necessity requires a shorter performance, any sub-section, or selected pages may be agreed upon by the ensemble prior to performance.

Performance Notes

Player 1

- **Acoustic Guitar** (steel-stringed) - can be plucked as either a single note or a dyad. If two tones are to be played; play the pitch specified in the score and an adjacent semitone (octave free). Players may alternatively choose to sustain a tone with a single bow stroke.
- **Vibraphone** - played with a soft mallet or bow; motor off and sustain pedal down. Where bowed, the duration of the tone is determined by a single, slow and even bow stroke.
- **Timpani** - each tuned to any pitch of the set: G, G#, A, A# in any octave; played as a single soft strike towards the rim, *pp*, possibly including one adjacent drum.
- **Bass Drum** - a single strike with large, soft mallet, *pp*.

(Performance notes, continued)

Player 2

- **Piano** - pitch indicated (octave free), possibly including one adjacent semitone. Sustain pedal depressed throughout. As with the guitars and zithers, the performer has the option of using electromagnetic sustainers. Artificially sustained notes can either be attacked as a hammered note, plucked from within the piano, or by silently raising the dampers allowing the string to slowly begin to resonate. Sustain for as long as possible until the performer must prepare for the next event.
- **Triangle** - struck either with a rubber-headed mallet, *p*, or with a metal beater, *ppp*.
- **Cymbal** - a single strike with soft mallet, *pp*, or triangle beater, *pppp*.
- **Floor Tom** - a single strike with soft timpani mallet, *pp*.

Player 3

- **Glockenspiel** - played with a soft (rubber) mallet or bow. Where bowed, the duration of the tone is determined by a single, slow and even bow stroke.
- **Tubular Bells** - either struck with a soft mallet, or played with a single bow stroke. Optionally, a player may strike a dyad of the specified pitch and an adjacent semitone.
- **Double Bass** - either *pizzicato* or *arco*. Where the performer chooses to play *arco*, two tones *may* be played in unison: the pitch specified in the score, and either a semitone above or below the specified pitch (octave free). The duration of the tone(s) is determined by a single bow stroke, or until the player must prepare for the next event.
- **Tamtam** - bowed softly, or a single strike with large, soft mallet, *ppp*.

(Performance notes, continued)

Player 4

- **Zither** - same rules as the guitars. Sustained notes can either be attacked as a plucked note which is then artificially sustained, or simply allow the string to slowly begin to resonate by itself.
- **Trombone** (with mute) - pitch indicated (octave free). Optionally, the performer may play a slow glissando from the specified pitch to any adjacent semitone. The duration is a single (long) breath, or ending in time to prepare for the next event. Onset and offsets should be as quiet as possible.
- **Triangle** - struck either with a rubber-headed mallet, *p*, or with a metal beater, *ppp*.
- **Bass Drum** - a single strike with large, soft mallet, *pp*.

Player 5

- **Electric Guitar** - can be either plucked or sustained with an electromagnetic resonator. If the instrument is to be plucked, two tones should be played in unison: the pitch specified in the score, and a semitone adjacent to the specified pitch (octave free). Where an artificial sustainer is used, the tone should last as long as possible before the player must prepare for the next event. The tone should decay naturally by removing or cutting power to the electromagnetic field. As an alternative to electromagnetic sustain, players may use a bow.
- **Zither** - same rules as the guitars. Sustained notes can either be attacked as a plucked note which is then artificially sustained, or simply allow the string to slowly begin to resonate by itself.
- **Cymbal** - a single strike with soft mallet, *pp*, or triangle beater, *pppp*.
- **Timpano** - a single drum, tuned to any pitch of the set: G, G#, A, A# - in any octave; played as a single soft strike towards the rim, *pp*.

(Performance notes, continued)

Player 6

- **Sine Waves** - a software instrument should produce a single sine wave with an attack of 3.5 seconds, a sustain of between 14 and 28 seconds, and a decay of 14 seconds. The pitch is any randomly generated frequency (Hz, not tempered, octave free) between the interval of $G < A\#$. The tone should be permitted to sustain *beyond* the onset of the next event if necessary.

A note on sustaining instruments

For each event, the decision to sustain a sonority or simply let it decay is left to the individual performer. However, where the interval between an attack and its successive event is significant (i.e. longer than approximately 30 seconds), methods to sustain at least one sonority within the ensemble are encouraged where possible. A sustained sound should never cause a performer to miss their next event. As such, sustained tones should finish naturally, allowing a comfortable amount of time to prepare for the next event.

Oliver Thurley, Autumn 2013

Tide

Oliver Thurley, 2013

let ring...
very softly

